

Here is the truth about getting ripped

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 27, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/w_C_9AlpSmk Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter rapid-fires answers to five "can you get shredded if..." myths, confirming carbs and late meals are fine, warning that poor sleep kills muscle retention, and stressing that lifting is essential for looking athletic.

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Can You Get Shredded Eating Carbs Every Day? 0:00

- **Yes** — carbs are not a barrier to getting lean
 - "Tons of people eat carbs all the time, tons of carbs, and they're in amazing shape."
 - Brandon himself has been keto for 11 years, but explicitly says he does it for reasons other than body composition
 - His bottom line: if body composition is your only goal, whether you eat carbs is entirely up to personal preference

Can You Get Shredded on 5 Hours of Sleep or Less? 0:22

- **Probably not** — this is the one factor he treats as a real obstacle
 - The threshold he cites: once you drop **under 6 hours** of sleep, problems begin
 - Even in a caloric deficit, the body will still lose weight — but the composition shifts unfavorably
 - You start losing **more muscle than fat**
 - The hormonal reason: key hormones like testosterone are produced at night
 - Less sleep = less testosterone production = worse muscle retention
 - Aside (self-deprecating): "I inject mine" — acknowledging he uses TRT

Can You Get Shredded Eating After 8 PM? 0:22

- **100% yes** — meal timing at night is a non-issue
 - Brandon says he can't remember the last time his final meal was before 8 PM
 - Implies the "don't eat after 8" rule is a myth with no practical impact on body composition

Can You Get Shredded With Cheat Days? 0:45

- **Yes, technically** — but he personally stopped doing them
 - Stopped cheat days approximately **3 years ago**
 - His experience: the day after a cheat day he would have strong cravings for the exact foods he cheated with
 - Once he eliminated cheat days completely, **all cravings disappeared**
 - Made sticking to his diet significantly easier
 - Required less willpower and discipline overall

Cutting cheat days entirely removed cravings rather than creating them — making the diet easier, not harder.

Can You Get Shredded Without Lifting Weights? 0:45

- **You can lose weight, but you likely won't look the way you want**
 - Without resistance training, weight loss tends to produce a "skinny-fat" or underdeveloped look
 - His analogy: you may "end up looking like a middle school kid"
 - For women specifically: losing weight without lifting leads to loss of curves, potentially resulting in a less feminine silhouette
 - Caveat: "No shade if that's your goal" — he acknowledges it's a personal choice, but sets the expectation clearly